

IN ALL HUMILITY
Modi during the consecration ceremony at the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya, Jan. . 22, 2024



The Great Hindu Revival
Feb. 5, 2024

“A single sentence from Narendra Modi’s address at the consecration ceremony of the Balak Ram idol summed up the epochal nature of the event. Choking with emotion, the prime minister said, “Our Ram Lalla will no longer live in a tent, he will now reside in his divine mandir.” The imagery those words evoked encapsulated the century-old bloody struggle to build a mandir at what is believed to be the birthplace of one of the most revered deities of the Hindu pantheon.”

the aftermath of that event even as it propelled the rise of Hindutva in the country.

However, it would not be until November 9, 2019, that the way would finally be paved for the construction of the Ram temple. On that day, the judges awarded the disputed 2.77 acres to an especially constituted trust, even as it mandated a suitable alternative site for the Muslim party.

On January 22, 2024, four months before the general election, in the presence of 7,000 guests, UP chief minister Yogi Adityanath, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and Mahant Nritya Gopal Das, Narendra Modi conducted the pran pratishtha of the temple, consecrating the Balak Ram idol sculpted by Mysuru sculptor Arun Yogiraj. What followed was a renewed focus on other sites of religious contestation, even as the Ram temple became a defining marker in the long trajectory of the Hindutva movement. ■

